CHECKLIST HOUSE RULES

1. Use it every week
2. Start it at the front door
3. Follow the order shown
4. Complete the item and then check it off
5. Set up and stick to your role

1. Use it every week

Humans forget small details. That's a fact, studies show it, and our service as a sound team is full of these details: multiple things to switch on, many things to set up, many to check, and a bunch of people to liaise with. With all this, things *can* easily get forgotten, and they **are** forgotten, the studies prove themselves right in our team! But checklists, being an objective reminder of everything we need to do, help with this time and time again.

So, if humans are naturally bad at this, why don't people use checklists? Well, in a word - pride. We don't think we need them. We think we're too smart, too experienced and too in control to need a checklist to remind us to do the things we do every week. We might not actively think this way but, given that we know humans are biologically deficient in spotting and remembering small details (ask me about the backing for this), not looking for an aid to this whispers "yeh but I'm fine, that doesn't apply to me"

Guy Spier, one of the few investors not to crash and burn during the 2008 financial crisis, and in fact one who managed to record his highest profits since he began trading in this year, experienced this problem first-hand. When asked by other investors how he managed not to just to stay afloat but to soar during this time he replied, "checklists", and they hung up the phone. They didn't want to hear it. They thought it too simple, and therefore beneath them.

We, as Christians, should of all people know that we aren't what we ought to be. We're deficient in so much, this is why we need a Saviour and this is why we need help to do the things we want to do. Seeking for, asking for, and using that help when it comes should be second nature to us.

So, let's use these checklists every week to ensure we're setting up all we need to; to help the word go out as clearly as possible, so people can respond as uninhibitedly as possible.

2. Follow the order shown

The items are in this order for a reason, either ordered in terms of importance or convenience ie, if the internet doesn't work or slides aren't in the folder we need time to sort that. We don't want to find that out 10 minutes before the service starts.

3. Start it at the front door

The steps start from the front door.

4. Complete the item and then check it off

You'll be far more likely to do the step if you check off as you go.

5. Set Up and stick to your role

It's great that we so often want to help each other in set up, however everything you do to assist in another role takes away the opportunity for someone else to learn. Sticking to your role's set up helps you focus on, take ownership of, and master your role. If you find yourself finished and twiddling your thumbs, maybe practice something you're rusty on e.g. switching to and from the stream, or switching to and from the slides etc. Or maybe look at tweaking the balance or EQ of the instruments to make that violin sing! There's a wealth of things you can do to make sure you're as ready for the service as you can be.